

it. However, the list of compatible third-party apps with the Toyota infotainment system is very limited as of now, and only includes second-tier apps and services like DMPlayer for music, and so on. While this app store may be built upon in future with more consistent connectivity and developer support, it remains an extra feature that will not really be used much, at least as of now.

The technology arsenal of the infotainment system is very similar to what Honda provides with its DigiPad. While DigiPad is purely based on Android, the Toyota system mimics Android-like functionality to the hilt, and that's a good thing. Comparatively, the Yaris gets the upper hand over Honda City's DigiPad, being the smoother system among the two. However, the navigation system appears to work better with Honda's unit, and we wish Toyota made the interface look slightly less jovial.

One big advantage that Toyota has with its display is its tilt-up function, which allows you to adjust the angle of the display's inclination by 90 degrees, facing outward.

The 4.2-inch MID in the instrument cluster is an interesting addition as well. The full-colour display shows a whole array of information, including outside temperature display, a fuel efficiency leaderboard that urges you to drive more efficiently, digital speedometer, eco-mode savings and entertainment and phone controls, alongside the usual trip and odometers. It is fairly easy to control via the steering-mounted buttons, and helps you navigate through a considerable range of options without having to fully divert your eyes.

SAFETY AND OTHER ELECTRONICS

Safety-wise, the Toyota Yaris includes seven airbags, ABS with EBD and Brake Assist as standard across all variants. The top-of-the-line VX vari-

ant includes Hill Start Assist, Stability Control, Tyre Pressure Monitor, front and rear parking sensors with dynamic rear parking camera, speed-sensing auto door-lock, impact-sensing auto lock-opening, follow-me-home headlamps, ISOFIX mounts in rear seats, rear defogger and rain-sensing wipers, making it one of the most richly-equipped cars in terms of its safety quotient. The tyre pressure monitor is unique to its segment, and the overall package easily outdoes the safety package in top trims as offered by other similar variants of its competitors.

In terms of other equipment, the Yaris features acoustic and heat-insulated glass, rear sunblind, eight-way power-adjustable driver seat, paddle shifters (in the VX trim), LED projector headlamps, six speakers that deliver reasonably decent audio, keyless entry and ignition, electronically-folding ORVMs and automatic climate control. The most unique bit

here are the roof-mounted rear air-conditioning vents with cool blue ambient LED lights with an adjustable flap to control direction of air flow.

DESIGN AND QUALITY

The Toyota Yaris has been referred to as a mini Corolla Altis by many, based on the sheer number of features that it comes with. The Yaris tends to grow on you as you see it more, and while it may not win awards for the flow of design, it is functional, and makes for a refreshing addition to India's car market.

Inside, the overall dashboard is designed smartly. However, this is where I had the biggest issue with the Yaris - while the interiors are designed fairly well, everything inside is a bit too plasticky. While the use of plastic is justified considering its pricing and the amount of features

that are on offer, Toyota could have applied better quality of material and a better overall touch to the finesse. On road, it is this that tends to disappear about the Yaris, and owing to the constant rattles and the hard touch of the plastics used, it is hard to ignore.

DRIVE AND RIDE QUALITY

The Toyota Yaris is powered by a 1.5-litre, 4-cylinder petrol engine that produces 106 bhp and 140 Nm torque. This is combined with either

6-speed manual or 7-speed CVT gearboxes, commendably across all trims.

While fuel efficiency for our automatic variant of the Yaris is rated at 17.8 kmpl, we obtained an average of 13.2 kmpl, which goes down to 12.1 kmpl in peak city congestion and rises up to 15.5 kmpl on the highway, which is not bad at all.

In terms of ride quality, the suspension is a tad firmer than what we would have hoped. Potholes

are managed well and the vehicle does feel sure-footed, but there is a slight, occasional jitter that occurs when you hit a large pothole. On the highway, it feels well planted, and the 15-inch alloys suit the car well both in terms of its road balance and the overall aesthetics.

BOTTOMLINE

The Toyota Yaris is here to stay, and eat up a share of the same cake over which Honda, Hyundai and Maruti Suzuki have been fighting over for a while now. The Yaris is a segment-leader in terms of its features and safety equipment, and if you want a very well-equipped car, you can certainly go ahead and book your Yaris. That said, both the Honda City and the Hyundai Verna still offer better interior quality, and in our books, better overall design and elegance. 

- **Price:** ₹14,07,000 (ex-show-room, India)
- **Powertrain:** 1.5-litre, 4-cylinder petrol, 106 bhp, 140 Nm, Seven-speed CVT
- **Fuel economy:** 13.2 kmpl (obtained)
- **Pros:** Incredibly feature-loaded, Class-leading safety equipment, Roof-mounted AC vents provide better airflow, Spacious and comfortable.
- **Cons:** Interiors are too plasticky, Dashboard rattles despite being new, Infotainment interface a bit childish.